

THE EQUITY EXPRESSION OF THE HUMANOID ROBOTS THESIS

The Robot Nobody Employs

For two years the humanoid robot has been argued about as a technology. Last week it was finally argued about as a price. Unitree Robotics listed in Shanghai on 19 August, closed its first session 460 per cent above the offer, briefly carried a market value near sixty-six billion dollars, and by 25 August had given back roughly 45 per cent of that peak.

The prospectus is the more interesting document. It shows a company that is unusually profitable — and it shows exactly who is paying. Almost three-quarters of Unitree's humanoid revenue in the first nine months of 2025 came from universities and research institutes. Nine per cent came from anything industrial. That is the whole argument, in one disclosure.

A reframe worth holding onto

13D Research has argued since January 2025 that the decisive variable is cost: humanoid unit prices falling from \$250,000 towards \$20,000–30,000, meeting a wall of unfilled jobs, with Robots-as-a-Service at \$2–8 an hour against a \$35 US factory wage. The reframe is that adoption is an arithmetic problem, not a technology problem — once the hourly cost crosses under the wage, demand is close to inelastic. Ignacio de Gregorio of The White Box supplies the counterweight from the capability side: the constraint is not price but reliability, and reliability is the one curve that has not yet bent.

Method. External figures come from Unitree's STAR Market prospectus as reported by 36Kr and Caixin, from press coverage of the 19 August listing, from company announcements, and from Morgan Stanley research as reported; each is dated where it appears. Internal figures come from the Heyokha research Wiki, attributed to the named provider — that provider's view on a stated date, not a house forecast and not verified fact. Where the two disagree, the disagreement is stated and left standing.

Imagine a firm that builds an extraordinary commercial oven, faster and more precise than anything else made, and sells it beautifully — to catering colleges. Colleges have equipment budgets, buy once every few years, do not haggle, and care that the machine demonstrates well rather than that it survives a decade of double shifts. The firm earns a sixty per cent gross margin, because the price is set by what a teaching budget will bear. Then a chain of four hundred staff canteens asks the only question a canteen ever asks: what does this cost per meal, and how often does it break? At that moment the price stops being set by an institution's budget and starts being set by the wage of the person currently doing the job — and the machine must run eight hours a day without a technician beside it. Both markets are real. Only one is the market the valuation is describing.

THE STORY IN 60 SECONDS

+460%

Unitree's first-day gain on the STAR Market, closing at ¥845 against a ¥150.80 offer. Peak valuation near US\$66bn; by 25 August roughly 45% below that. *Press reports, 19–25 Aug 2026*

9%

Share of Unitree's humanoid revenue from genuine industrial application, 9M 2025. Research and education took 73.6%; commercial consumption 17.4%. *Prospectus, 20 March 2026*

¥167,600

Average humanoid selling price, 9M 2025 — down from ¥593,400 in 2023, while gross margin rose from 44.2% in 2022 to 60.3%. *Prospectus, 20 March 2026*

WHAT ACTUALLY HAPPENED

A listing, a prospectus, and a very fast round trip

Unitree Robotics was founded in Hangzhou in 2016 and spent its first five years selling quadruped robots — robot dogs — largely to overseas research institutions. It moved to humanoids in 2023 and became a household name in China after a Spring Festival Gala appearance. On 20 March 2026 the Shanghai Stock Exchange accepted its application to list on the STAR Market. The China Securities Regulatory Commission approved the registration on 1 July, 104 days later, the fastest turnaround in the board's history. Shares were priced at ¥150.80 on 6 August, raising about ¥6.1bn (roughly US\$904m) at a valuation near US\$9bn. Retail subscription was reported at some eight thousand times covered.

Trading began on 19 August. The stock opened at ¥1,100 and closed at ¥845 — 460 per cent above the offer. At its intraday high the company was worth roughly US\$66bn. Then it fell. By 25 August it had shed about 45 per cent from that peak, taking some US\$30bn of market value with it. The mechanics of the round trip are partly structural rather than sentimental: newly listed Chinese stocks are difficult to sell short, and retail participation in STAR Market debuts is heavy, so first-day pops are large by construction — the average first-day gain across Chinese IPOs over the prior three years has been reported near 226 per cent. Unitree's was double that, and the subsequent give-back was correspondingly large.

What did not change in either direction was the prospectus. Unitree reported 2025 revenue of ¥1.708bn, up 335 per cent year on year, with net profit excluding non-recurring items of about ¥600m, up 674 per cent, on a main-business gross margin of 60.3 per cent. It shipped more than 5,500 humanoid units in 2025, more than any other company in the world. Hardware cost is reported at roughly ¥60,000–70,000 per unit against an average selling price of ¥167,600. On any conventional reading this is a good business. Selling robots has been more profitable than selling cars: Unitree's humanoid gross margin of 62.9 per cent compares with roughly 18 per cent at Tesla and 15 per cent at Xiaomi over the same period.

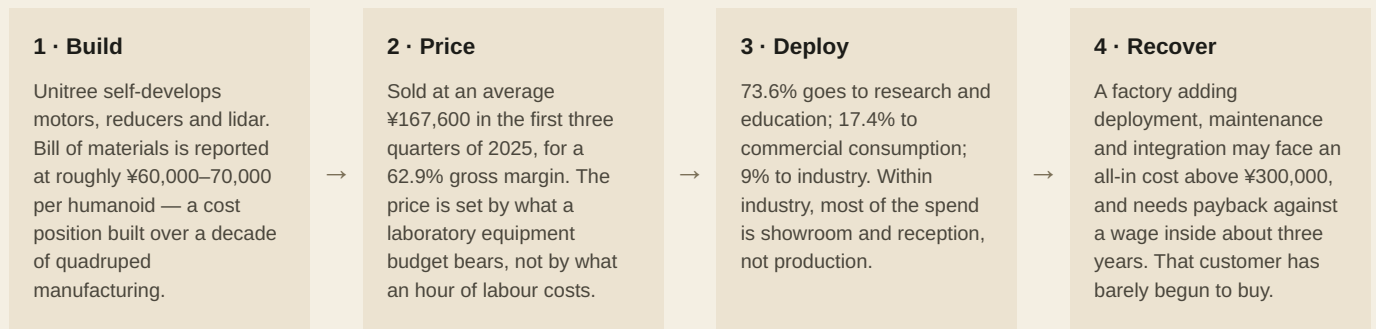
The disclosure that reframes all of it sits further down. In the first three quarters of 2025, research and education accounted for 73.6 per cent of humanoid revenue, commercial consumption for 17.4 per cent, and real industrial application for 9 per cent. And within that industrial slice, the revenue attributable to clearly productive uses — intelligent manufacturing, inspection, logistics — was ¥15.7m from January to September 2025, less than a third of the industrial total. The remainder was corporate tours and reception duty. Unitree's customers, in other words, are buying an instrument and a showpiece. They are not buying labour.

THE ESSENTIAL DISTINCTION

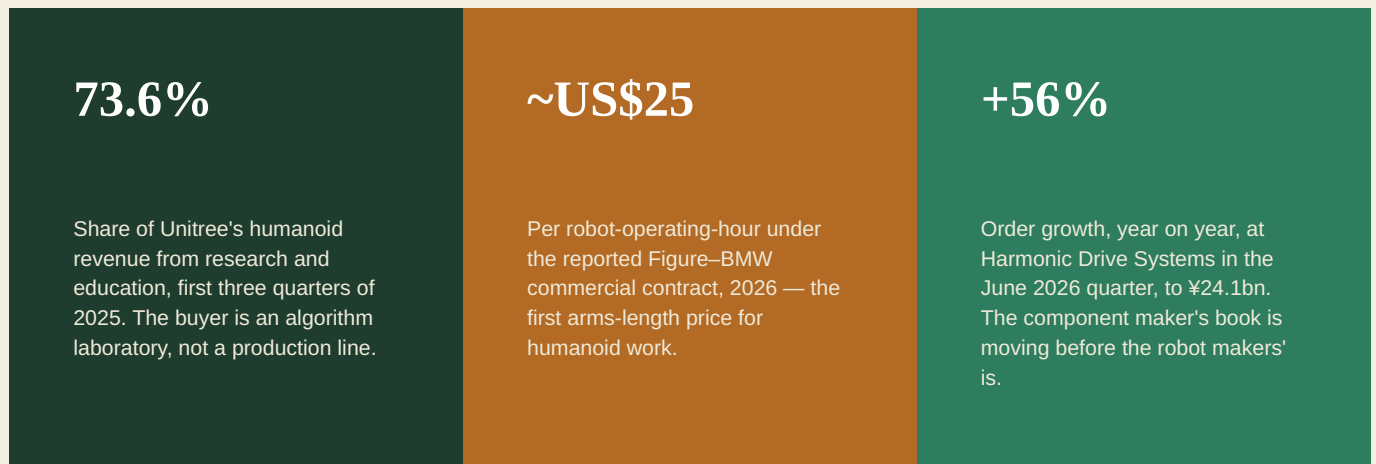
A robot sold is not a robot employed. Unit shipments measure how many institutions want to study the machine; only hours worked at a price a factory will pay measure whether it has become labour. *These two numbers have been growing at very different rates, and the second one is barely reported.*

MECHANISM

Following one machine through its economics



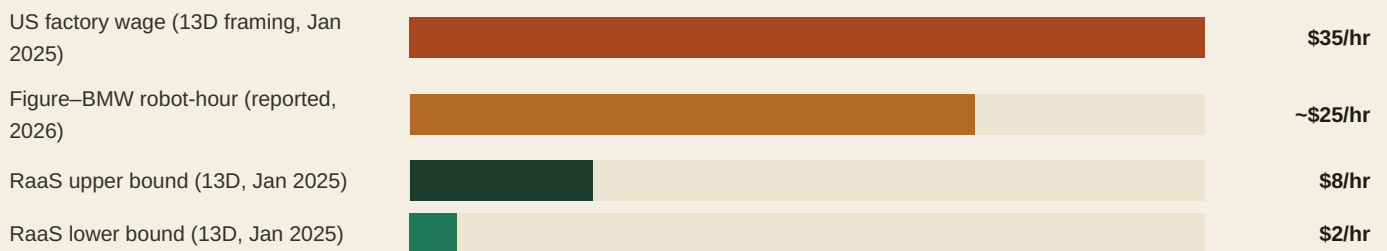
Source: Unitree STAR Market prospectus as reported by 36Kr, 23 March and 24 April 2026; all-in deployment cost above ¥300,000 is 36Kr's estimate, not a company figure. Steps describe reported unit economics for one manufacturer and should not be generalised to the sector.



Sources: Unitree prospectus via 36Kr (20 March 2026); reported Figure AI–BMW commercial agreement following the Spartanburg pilot (2026); Harmonic Drive Systems June-quarter results, sales ¥16.7bn (+24% y/y), operating margin 11%. Harmonic Drive's order book spans industrial robotics and semiconductor equipment as well as humanoids; it is not a pure humanoid read.

THE COMPARISON THE ARGUMENT TURNS ON

What an hour of work costs



Bars are illustrative and scaled to the \$35 wage figure. The \$2–8 range and the \$35 wage are 13D Research's framing from its 16 January 2025 WILTW as recorded on the internal Wiki; they are that provider's view, not verified market prices. The ~\$25 figure is the reported commercial rate in the Figure AI–BMW agreement and covers a robot supplied, maintained and supported by the vendor — a different bundle from a wage, and not directly comparable. The comparison is shown because the two numbers are used interchangeably in sector commentary; they should not be.

A USEFUL MENTAL MODEL

Price the machine the way a factory prices a shift, not the way a laboratory prices an instrument. A laboratory asks what a thing costs. A factory asks what it costs per hour, how many hours it runs before it stops, and who pays when it does. *Only the second set of questions produces a market measured in trillions.*

WHAT HAS ACTUALLY SHIFTED

Five changes, each cutting both ways

WHAT HAS CHANGED	WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE IN THE DATA	WHY IT CUTS BOTH WAYS
The sector has a public price	Unitree listed 19 August 2026 at ¥150.80, closed day one at ¥845 (+460%), then fell roughly 45% from its intraday peak by 25 August.	Transparency is real progress — Figure AI's US\$39bn is a private mark, Unitree's is not. But a price set by a retail market that cannot sell short is a poor instrument for discovering value.
Profitability has been demonstrated	2025 revenue ¥1.708bn (+335%); adjusted net profit about ¥600m (+674%); main-business gross margin 60.3%; 5,500+ humanoids shipped.	It proves humanoids can be sold at a margin. It does not prove they can be sold to the customer the thesis depends on: the profit comes from the market with the lower ceiling.
Prices are falling fast	Average selling price ¥593,400 (2023) → ¥260,700 (2024) → ¥167,600 (9M 2025), while gross margin rose from 44.2% to over 60%.	The cost curve is bending as the bulls claimed. But falling price with rising margin implies the decline is being funded by scale and integration, not competed away — which is a fragile arrangement once rivals arrive.
The first arms-length work contract exists	Figure AI's Spartanburg pilot with BMW ran 1,250 operating hours and contributed to over 30,000 X3s, reportedly moving to a commercial fleet at about US\$25 per robot-hour.	This is the sector's most important datapoint: someone is finally buying hours, not units. But at ~\$25 an hour it sits far closer to the wage than the \$2–8 the internal thesis assumes.
Forecasts are being revised up, repeatedly	Morgan Stanley lifted its 2026 China humanoid shipment forecast to 50,000 units in June 2026, from 28,000, itself raised from 14,000 — three revisions inside a year.	Rapid upward revision usually means something real is happening. It also means the forecast has no anchor, and the same process can run in reverse if the industrial customer stays absent.

The two cases

The bull case

- **The cost curve is bending, and it is documented.** Unitree's average selling price fell from ¥593,400 in 2023 to ¥167,600 in the first three quarters of 2025 — a two-thirds decline in two years, achieved while gross margin expanded. This is the pattern the internal thesis predicted, and it is now in an audited filing rather than a projection.
- **Someone is paying for hours.** Figure AI's robots ran 1,250 hours at BMW Spartanburg with reported placement accuracy above 99 per cent, and the pilot converted into a commercial contract. That is the transition from demonstration to procurement that the sceptics said had not happened.
- **The component order book is already moving.** Harmonic Drive Systems booked ¥24.1bn of orders in the June 2026 quarter, up 56 per cent year on year, on sales up 24 per cent. Precision reducers are a bottleneck input; order growth ahead of revenue growth is what a genuine ramp looks like from the supplier's side.
- **Scale is arriving from China's playbook, not from a single champion.** 13D Research counted China as controlling 63 per cent of the humanoid supply chain, deploying two-thirds of the world's humanoids, filing roughly 5,600 humanoid patents against a quarter as many in the US, and committing over \$20bn of public and private capital (WILTW, 21 August 2025). That is the photovoltaic and EV sequence, and it worked twice.
- **The capability constraint is loosening.** Generalist's GEN-1.5, introduced 19 August 2026, learns simple physical tasks from a single 3–12 second demonstration with no gradient updates: 59 per cent success across ten manipulation tasks from one example, 83 per cent with five minutes of task data. De Gregorio's reading is that this rhymes with language models in 2020.
- **The demand pull is demographic and does not need a cycle.** The internal view counts 8.1m unfilled US jobs and dependency ratios reaching 25 per cent in the US, 35 per cent in Western Europe and 50 per cent in Japan by 2030. Labour that does not exist cannot be hired at any wage.

The bear case

- **The profitable customer is the wrong customer.** 73.6 per cent of Unitree's humanoid revenue came from research and education, 9 per cent from industry, and within industry most spending was on reception and tours. 36Kr's estimate of the global research market's capacity is roughly 10,000 units — about two years of Unitree's current shipments.
- **Growth is already decelerating and profit is already falling.** Unitree's third-quarter 2025 revenue fell 26 per cent sequentially as the Spring Festival effect faded. First-quarter 2026 adjusted net profit fell 53 per cent year on year to about ¥40m. The reported figures postdate the euphoria they are meant to justify.
- **The industrial path destroys capital, on the evidence available.** UBTECH chose factories rather than laboratories, spent ¥478m on R&D in 2024 against Unitree's ¥90m in the first three quarters of 2025, delivered fewer than 500 Walker S units in 2024, and lost roughly ¥790m in 2025 on about ¥2bn of revenue. The market the bulls want is the market that has so far consumed cash.
- **Reliability, not price, is the binding constraint.** De Gregorio's standing objection survives GEN-1.5: most demonstrated tasks "barely reach even 90 per cent accuracy" where production needs 99.9 per cent or better, and the tasks remain short-horizon. He explicitly declines the full "ChatGPT moment" label (The White Box, 22 August 2026).
- **The valuation arithmetic is severe.** Unitree's pre-IPO mark of about ¥42bn implied roughly 70 times 2025 adjusted profit. On our arithmetic, the intraday peak near US\$66bn implied something on the order of 780 times, and the 25 August level roughly 425 times. Neither is a price for a business; both are prices for an option.
- **A Western incumbent is selling, not buying.** ABB abandoned its planned robotics spin-off and agreed instead to divest the division to SoftBank at an enterprise value of US\$5.375bn, expected to close in mid-to-late 2026. A \$2.3bn-revenue robotics business changing hands at that multiple is a sober mark beside the pure-plays.

Where internal and external part company most sharply is on the hourly cost of robot labour. The internal Wiki page carries 13D Research's Robots-as-a-Service framing of \$2–8 per hour against a \$35 US factory wage — the arithmetic that makes adoption look inevitable. The only arms-length commercial rate now reported anywhere in the sector, from the Figure–BMW agreement, is roughly \$25 per robot-hour. The two are not strictly comparable: the \$25 covers a vendor-supplied, vendor-maintained, vendor-supported fleet, and it is an early price for a novel service with no competitive market behind it, so it should fall. But the gap is between three-fold and twelve-fold, and it is the difference between a technology that displaces labour on arrival and one that has to wait for another decade of cost decline before it does. There is a second, quieter divergence: the internal page's list of key players still names ABB as an equity expression of the theme, and ABB is in the process of leaving the business. We do not resolve either conflict here. We note that the internal page was last reviewed on 24 August 2026 and that neither the BMW rate nor the SoftBank transaction has yet been written into it.

WHAT TO WATCH FROM HERE

The dashboard

SIGNAL	PLAIN-ENGLISH READING	WHY IT MATTERS
UBTech interim results, 28 August 2026	The board meets on 28 August to approve first-half figures. Watch the humanoid segment revenue line and the loss, not the order announcements.	UBTech is the listed company that chose the factory over the laboratory. Its numbers are the cleanest available test of whether industrial humanoids can be sold at a margin.
Unitree against its ¥150.80 offer price	The offer price was struck by institutions at a roughly US\$9bn valuation. Everything above it was set in the aftermarket.	How far the stock settles above the institutional mark is the market's own estimate of how much of the move was structure and how much was conviction.
Robot-hour pricing in the next fleet contract	Any published rate on a Figure, Appttronik or Agility deployment — and whether it prints below or above the reported ~\$25.	This is the single number that decides the theme. It is the only one that measures robots as labour rather than as equipment.
Harmonic Drive Systems order intake	Whether the 56 per cent June-quarter order growth persists into the September quarter, and whether management attributes it to humanoids.	Component order books lead assembler revenue by two to four quarters. If orders roll over before humanoid shipments rise, the ramp was inventory.
Morgan Stanley's 50,000-unit China forecast	Actual 2026 Chinese shipments against the June 2026 forecast of 50,000 units, itself twice revised upward.	Three upward revisions in a year is either genuine acceleration or a forecast with no anchor. The out-turn distinguishes them.
Nvidia's second quarter, reported today	Nvidia reports fiscal Q2 2027 after the US close on 26 August, against guidance of about \$91bn. Robotics disclosure sits inside a rounding error.	Nvidia supplies the training stack the whole theme depends on. What matters here is not the headline but whether robotics is yet material enough to be broken out at all.

THREE POSTURES, NOT ONE ANSWER

Coherent ways to hold the theme

Own the input Precision reducers, high-torque actuators, rare-earth magnets. These sell into every humanoid regardless of which brand wins, and the order books move first. The cost: the exposure is diluted — most of these order books are dominated by industrial robotics and semiconductor equipment, so you take the cyclicalities of those end-markets while waiting for a humanoid signal you may never cleanly observe.	Own the deployer The manufacturers that actually cut labour cost — carmakers, logistics operators, contract assemblers. If humanoids work, the value accrues to whoever removes the wage. The cost: the benefit is small relative to the enterprise, arrives slowly, and is nearly impossible to isolate in a margin line. You may be right about the theme and never see it in the position.	Own the pure-play Unitree, UBTech and the private field. This is the only way to capture the full move if the industrial customer arrives. The cost: you are buying an option, priced by a retail market where short selling is restricted, on a business whose profitable revenue comes from a market with a low ceiling. Options expire, and this one has a long time to run before it pays.
The companies named in this edition are illustrative of the mechanics discussed. They are NOT recommendations, and nothing here constitutes investment advice. Several are unprofitable, several trade on valuations that embed outcomes no filing yet supports, and one is not accessible to most non-mainland investors.		

688836

UNITREE ROBOTICS · SHANGHAI STAR MARKET

Listed 19 Aug 2026
-45% from peak, 25 Aug

The first pure-play humanoid maker with a public price. Profitable and fast-growing — ¥1.708bn revenue in 2025, about ¥600m adjusted net profit, 60.3% gross margin, 5,500-plus units shipped. Also the company whose prospectus disclosed that 73.6% of humanoid revenue came from research and education and 9% from industry. Both facts are true at once, which is what makes it the sector's defining document.

WATCH NEXT

Whether the research-and-education revenue mix falls in the next reporting period — the only evidence that the industrial customer has begun to arrive.

9880.HK

UBTECH ROBOTICS · HONG KONG

Interim results due
28 Aug 2026

The mirror image. UBTech aimed at factory floors — collaborative trials at BYD, Geely, Mercedes-Benz, Audi, Zeekr and Foxconn — and paid for it: roughly ¥790m of losses in 2025 on about ¥2bn of revenue, following ¥1.12bn of losses in 2024, with R&D of ¥478m in 2024. Fewer than 500 Walker S units delivered in 2024. The harder path, with the larger prize if it survives the cash burn.

WATCH NEXT

The 28 August interim: humanoid segment revenue and gross margin, and whether the loss is narrowing or the burn is accelerating.

6324.JP

HARMONIC DRIVE SYSTEMS · TOKYO

Orders +56% y/y
June quarter 2026

The bottleneck. Harmonic Drive holds the leading global share in precision strain-wave reducers, the component that gives a robot joint its accuracy, and is one of very few firms able to supply them at humanoid scale and tolerance. June-quarter sales of ¥16.7bn were up 24% year on year at an 11% operating margin; orders rose 56% to ¥24.1bn. Orders running well ahead of sales is the classic supplier-side signature of a build.

WATCH NEXT

Whether management attributes order growth to humanoids specifically, or to industrial robotics and semiconductor equipment — the two are easily conflated.

NVDA

NVIDIA · NASDAQ

Q2 FY27 reported
after close, 26 Aug 2026

The training stack. Nvidia's Cosmos world-model platform and its simulation tools are how most humanoid developers generate the physical-interaction data they cannot collect in the real world. It is also the clearest illustration of how small this theme still is: data centre revenue was \$75.2bn in the April quarter, over 92% of everything the company sold, and robotics does not warrant separate disclosure.

WATCH NEXT

Tonight's guidance against roughly \$91bn, and whether robotics is mentioned as a revenue line rather than a roadmap.

ABBN.SW

ABB · SIX SWISS EXCHANGE

Robotics divestment
US\$5.375bn EV

The seller. ABB planned to spin its robotics division off as a separately listed company in the second quarter of 2026, then abandoned that in favour of a sale to SoftBank Group at an enterprise value of US\$5.375bn, expected to close in mid-to-late 2026. The division had 2024 revenues of about \$2.3bn at a 12.1% operational EBITA margin. A sober valuation mark, agreed between two industrial parties, sitting beside the pure-plays.

WATCH NEXT

Completion of the SoftBank transaction, and what SoftBank chooses to do with an established industrial robotics installed base.

6680.HK

JL MAG RARE EARTH · HONG KONG

40,000t nameplate 2025
→ 60,000t by 2028

The material. Each humanoid requires roughly 4kg of rare-earth permanent magnets, on 13D's estimate — which is why the robot thesis and the critical-minerals thesis are the same trade wearing different clothes. JL Mag is the world's largest sintered permanent magnet manufacturer and already supplies magnetic components into the humanoid sector. China accounts for about 94% of global sintered magnet supply.

WATCH NEXT

Whether humanoid-related magnet volumes are disclosed separately, and how Chinese export licensing treats magnets destined for robotics.

The bottom line

What was repriced last week was not humanoid robotics. It was the discovery that the sector's most successful company earns its money from laboratories. The listing gave the theme a public price; the prospectus gave it a public customer list; and the two were not compatible at US\$66bn. The subsequent 45 per cent decline is best read not as a verdict on the technology but as the market reconciling a valuation drawn from the industrial market with revenue drawn from the research one.

The evidence is genuinely mixed, and it would be dishonest to tidy it. The cost curve is bending exactly as the bulls said it would, the component order books are moving, and for the first time somebody is buying robot hours rather than robot units. Against that: the only company earning good money is earning it from a market 36Kr estimates it could exhaust in about two years, the company chasing the real market is losing roughly ¥790m a year doing so, and the one published price for a robot hour is around \$25 rather than the \$2–8 the thesis assumes. The reasonable inference is that this is early — a real industry forming, priced as though it had already formed. The next test is close and specific: UBTech's interim results on 28 August, and then the price printed on the next commercial fleet contract. Watch the second one hardest. It is the only number that tells you whether these machines have become labour.

Editorial note. This is educational commentary prepared for internal use at Heyokha Brothers. It is not investment advice, not a recommendation, and not a solicitation to buy or sell any security. Companies are named to illustrate the mechanics under discussion; their appearance implies no view on their merit as investments. External figures carry the date at which they were reported and have not been updated since; market prices and valuations change continuously. Internal views drawn from the firm's research Wiki are the opinions of the named research providers on the dates given, are labelled as views rather than forecasts, and have not been independently verified by us. Where internal and external sources conflict, we have stated the conflict and left it unresolved rather than choosing a side. Derived calculations are identified as ours. Readers should form their own judgements and take their own advice.

Sources and update notes

Internal. Principal page: *Humanoid Robots* (theme, status active), created 23 June 2026, last reviewed 24 August 2026, 1,508 words. Supporting pages: *1X* (company), created and last reviewed 15 July 2026; and the source-summary page for the 13D WILTW of 21 August 2025. The theme page rests on four provider issues. **13D Research WILTW, 16 January 2025** supplies the entire quantitative architecture: the ten converging technologies, the \$250,000-to-\$150,000 cost decline and \$20–30,000 trajectory, the Robots-as-a-Service range of \$2–8 per hour against a \$35 US factory wage, the 8.1m unfilled US jobs and the dependency-ratio projections, and the market-size table running from Goldman Sachs' \$38bn to Ark Invest's \$24tn. **13D Research WILTW, 21 August 2025** supplies the China supply-chain figures: 63 per cent of the global chain, two-thirds of global deployments, roughly 5,600 patents, over \$20bn of committed investment, Unitree G1 pricing under \$15,000, and approximately 4kg of rare-earth permanent magnets per unit. **The White Box (Ignacio de Gregorio), 12 July 2026** supplies the 1X hand assessment and the original "we're yet to hit robotics' ChatGPT moment" caution. **The White Box, 22 August 2026** — the newest issue in the Wiki and the reason this topic scored highest today — supplies the GEN-1.5 detail: 59 per cent one-shot success across ten manipulation tasks, 83 per cent with five minutes of data, and the reliability objection at 90 versus 99.9 per cent. A single **Marc Faber monthly report, 1 August 2026** entry records Unitree approaching its 10,000th shipment and the expected STAR Market listing, citing SemiAnalysis.

Limitation on the internal view. This page has a narrow provider base and an old spine. Two providers account for everything: 13D Research for the entire economic case, and one author — Ignacio de Gregorio of The White Box — for every 2026 capability update. Every cost figure, market-size estimate, labour-shortage statistic and RaaS price on the page traces to a single 13D issue dated 16 January 2025, now nineteen months old, and none has been re-verified since. De Gregorio is a technology analyst rather than an equity analyst: his contribution is rigorous on capability and silent on company economics. The consequence is that the page contains no independent internal financial work on any listed company in the theme — no view on Unitree's mix, no view on UBTech's losses, no view on valuation. The page's own Contradictions section records the timeline disagreement between 13D and de Gregorio honestly, which is to its credit, but a two-provider page cannot triangulate. Every company-level number in this edition therefore comes from external sources.

External. (1) Unitree STAR Market prospectus, accepted by the Shanghai Stock Exchange 20 March 2026, as reported by 36Kr on 23 March and 24 April 2026: 2025 revenue ¥1.708bn (+335% y/y); adjusted net profit about ¥600m (+674%); main-business gross margin 60.27%, humanoid gross margin 62.91%; 5,500-plus humanoid units shipped in 2025; average selling price ¥593,400 (2023), ¥260,700 (2024), ¥167,600 (9M 2025); hardware cost ¥60,000–70,000 per unit; revenue mix for the first three quarters of 2025 of 73.6% research and education, 17.39% commercial consumption, 9% industrial application; ¥15.702m of January–September 2025 revenue in clearly productive industrial scenarios; Q3 2025 revenue down 26% sequentially; R&D of ¥90m in the first three quarters of 2025; pre-IPO valuation about ¥42bn. (2) Listing coverage, 19–25 August 2026, via CNN, ColombiaOne citing AP, Caixin, CNBC and Global Times as compiled: offer price ¥150.80 set 6 August; approximately 40.44m shares for about ¥6.1bn (US\$904m) at roughly US\$9bn; CSRC approval 1 July,

104 days after acceptance; retail subscription about 8,000 times covered; debut 19 August opening ¥1,100 and closing ¥845, up 460%; intraday peak valuation about US\$66bn; down roughly 45% from peak by 25 August, erasing about US\$30bn; Q1 2026 adjusted net profit down 53% y/y to about ¥40m; average first-day gain across Chinese IPOs over the prior three years about 226%. (3) UBTech: 2024 revenue about ¥1.3bn with a ¥1.12bn loss and roughly 30% gross margin per Hong Kong Stock Exchange disclosure; 2025 revenue about ¥2bn with a loss of about ¥790m; R&D ¥478m in 2024; fewer than 500 Walker S units delivered in 2024; 1,079 full humanoids sold in 2025 for segment revenue of ¥820.6m; board meeting scheduled 28 August 2026 to approve interim results. (4) Figure AI and BMW: Spartanburg pilot with Figure 02 across 1,250 operating hours, over 90,000 parts loaded, contributing to more than 30,000 X3 vehicles at above 99% placement accuracy against an 84-second cycle time; commercial contract reported for an initial fleet of forty Figure 03 units at approximately US\$25 per robot-operating-hour; BMW expanding to Plant Leipzig from summer 2026. (5) Harmonic Drive Systems June 2026 quarter: sales ¥16.7bn (+24% y/y), operating margin 11%, orders ¥24.1bn (+56% y/y). (6) Nvidia: Q1 FY2027 revenue \$81.62bn (+85% y/y), data centre revenue \$75.2bn, over 92% of total; Q2 FY2027 guidance about \$91bn ±2%, reported after the US close on 26 August 2026. (7) ABB: April 2025 announcement of an intended 100% spin-off of the Robotics division with Q2 2026 listing, division 2024 revenue about \$2.3bn at 12.1% operational EBITA margin and approximately 7,000 employees; superseded by an agreement to divest the division to SoftBank Group at an enterprise value of US\$5.375bn, expected to close mid-to-late 2026. (8) Morgan Stanley, June 2026, as reported by CNBC and the South China Morning Post: 2026 China humanoid shipment forecast raised to 50,000 units from 28,000 and originally 14,000; China humanoid market of about \$2bn in 2026 rising to \$15bn and 446,000 annual shipments by 2030; average unit cost about \$50,000 in 2024 falling to roughly \$30,000 by 2030. (9) Tesla: Optimus 3 production stated by Elon Musk to begin in summer 2026 with high volume from summer 2027 — a company statement, not an out-turn, and noted here only because the internal Wiki records SemiAnalysis's contrasting count of 150 Optimus units shipped last year against Unitree approaching 10,000.

Editorial choices in this automated run. Topic selection followed the standing method: entity scoring across Wiki sources published since 5 August 2026, with a bonus for entities named in a source title, filtered to active theme pages and then against a thirty-day no-repeat rule. Humanoid Robots was chosen because it is named in the headline of the newest source in the Wiki — The White Box of 22 August 2026, "Robotics' ChatGPT Moment" — which is the hot signal the method is designed to catch, and because it has never appeared in the archive. Three higher-scoring entities were set aside: AI Capex and Fiscal Dominance are inside the cooldown window, and Gold was set aside because the archive carries two Gold Miners editions inside thirty days (24 July and 5 August) and a third gold-family edition would breach the spirit of the rule if not its letter. That judgement is a departure from a strictly literal reading of the cooldown and is flagged here. The cooldown check itself was complete: the HB Wiki Learning folder was read directly and every one of the twenty-four archived editions parsed, covering 24 July to 25 August 2026 — no inference was required. Two tooling notes. The Wiki theme catalogue exceeded the response limit and was queried by pattern-matching the saved output rather than read whole, so the eligible universe was confirmed by slug list rather than by reading each page summary. And the reported first-day figures for Unitree conflict across secondary sources, with some giving a 487% close and a US\$53bn valuation; we used the ¥845 close and +460% because those two are arithmetically consistent with the ¥150.80 offer price, and we have flagged the peak and drawdown separately. UBTech's first-half 2026 figures were deliberately excluded despite appearing in one search result, because the board does not meet to approve them until 28 August; publishing them today would have been unverifiable. All price-earnings multiples for Unitree above the pre-IPO mark are our own arithmetic from two verified inputs and are labelled as such.

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